

TANK MAINTENANCE CHECKLIST

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Owner Reference Resource

Purpose

This resource is useful enough to help asset owners identify issues, keep useful records, and decide when to escalate – it is not a repair guide, design guide, or compliance certificate.

Practical asset-owner checklist for identifying tank condition issues and knowing when to escalate.

Important Scope Note

This guide is general information only. It does not replace a site-specific tank inspection, engineering assessment, safety review, or compliance certification.

Use it to identify what should be noticed, photographed, recorded, and escalated. Do not use it to select repair methods, coating systems, liner systems, structural remedies, or replacement scope.

What This Guide Helps You Do

- Check visible tank condition in a structured way.
- Record defects before they become harder to manage.
- Separate routine observations from issues that need specialist review.
- Decide when to request a formal inspection.

What This Guide Does Not Cover

- Structural calculations.
- Confined space entry.
- Coating or liner specification.
- Repair methods.
- Hot works, cutting, welding, or patching.
- Certification of tank condition.

Recommended Inspection Rhythm

Situation	Suggested Action
Routine asset management	Walk-around inspection on a planned interval based on tank criticality.
After severe weather	Check roof, access, vents, fittings, overflow and visible settlement.
After a leak, alarm or overflow	Record the event and arrange follow-up if the cause is not obvious.
Before planned outage	Complete a visual check and list items needing inspection access.
Critical supply or fire water asset	Use a shorter review cycle and keep photo records.

TANK MAINTENANCE CHECKLIST

Owner Walk-Around Checklist

Area	What To Look For	Status	Photo Ref / Notes
External shell	Rust staining, paint breakdown, deformation, impact damage, open joints.	Pass / Watch / Escalate	
Roof and hatch	Damaged roof sheets, loose hatch, missing fasteners, ponding, debris.	Pass / Watch / Escalate	
Access system	Ladder, platform, handrail, gate or fall protection damage.	Pass / Watch / Escalate	
Vents and screens	Blocked vents, damaged mesh, vermin entry points, corrosion.	Pass / Watch / Escalate	
Pipe fittings	Drips, staining, unsupported pipework, loose flanges or gasket failure.	Pass / Watch / Escalate	
Overflow	Blockage, erosion, discharge issue or signs of repeated overflow.	Pass / Watch / Escalate	
Base and foundation	Settlement, cracking, washout, soft ground, shell not sitting evenly.	Pass / Watch / Escalate	
Coating or liner	Blistering, peeling, cracking, discolouration, exposed substrate.	Pass / Watch / Escalate	
Surrounding area	Vegetation, access obstruction, trip hazards, chemical exposure nearby.	Pass / Watch / Escalate	

Photo Prompts

Take photos of:

- Full tank elevation from each accessible side.
- Base and foundation.
- Roof, hatch and access points.
- Pipe penetrations, overflow and vents.
- Any corrosion, staining, leak path or damaged lining.
- Any area that has changed since the last inspection.

Keep photos with the date, tank ID and location. The value is in comparing changes over time.

Priority Rating

Priority	Meaning	Typical Action
1 - Escalate now	Safety hazard, active leak, structural movement, unsafe access, rapid deterioration.	Request specialist review before normalising the issue.
2 - Plan review	Corrosion spreading, liner or coating failure, repeated fitting leaks, unclear defect.	Include in planned inspection or maintenance review.
3 - Monitor	Cosmetic wear, isolated staining, minor housekeeping defect.	Record and compare at next inspection.

TANK MAINTENANCE CHECKLIST

Call PC Tanks If You See

- Repeated leakage from the same area.
- Multiple corrosion points or corrosion spreading between inspections.
- Foundation movement, shell deformation or tank out-of-round condition.
- Unsafe ladder, platform, hatch or roof access.
- Liner or coating breakdown across more than a localised area.
- Any defect where the consequence of failure is high.

Final Check Before Filing

- Have photos been saved with the inspection record?
- Is each defect marked as Pass, Watch or Escalate?
- Is there a clear follow-up owner and date?
- Has any safety-critical issue been escalated instead of left as a note?

Next Step

If the checklist shows repeat defects, hidden corrosion, liner failure or uncertain structural condition, the next step is a site-specific tank assessment — not a self-managed repair.

PC Tanks has 20+ years inspecting and refurbishing water storage tanks across Australia and the Pacific. We will review the tank, your photo and inspection history, and advise whether maintenance, refurbishment, relining or replacement gives the lowest operational risk for the remaining asset life.

Request a tank assessment — call 1300 029 804, email info@pcwater.com.au, or visit pcwater.com.au.